

MARKET INTELLIGENCE

The 52% Problem

Why International Graduate Success Is Becoming Australia's Next Competitive Challenge

A data-led review of graduate outcomes, visa policy reform, and institutional risk across Australia, New Zealand, and five competitor study destinations

Prepared using the Pine International Employability Framework

Pine Careers | Global Higher Education Intelligence | July 2026

Executive Summary

For institutions dependent on international tuition revenue, declining graduate employability is no longer a careers-service footnote. It now represents a strategic recruitment, reputation, and regulatory risk -one that shows up in rankings performance, alumni engagement, employer partnerships, and ultimately in enrolment decisions made by the next cohort of prospective students and their families.

This paper applies the Pine International Employability Framework to three data sets that are rarely read together: official graduate outcomes data from Australia's QILT program, the full timeline of visa and migration policy change since 2021, and 2025 survey evidence of financial distress among currently enrolled international students. Read individually, each is a partial story. Read together, they describe a system in which policy tightening, a softening graduate labour market, and rising cost-of-living pressure are compounding at the same time, for the same cohort -with direct consequences for the metrics that define institutional success.

52.3% International undergraduate full-time employment rate, 2024 (vs. 74.0% domestic)	9 Major migration policy changes affecting international students since 2023	74% Of surveyed international students underestimated how hard it would be to find work (2025)
---	---	---

Three findings anchor this paper:

- The employability gap is widening, not closing. The full-time employment gap between domestic and international undergraduates grew from 19.3 percentage points in 2023 to 21.7 points in 2024; at the postgraduate coursework level, from 29.6 to 32.0 points.
- Visa policy has tightened on almost every axis simultaneously -English language thresholds, financial capacity requirements, visa fees, onshore pathway options, and (from 2025) enrolment caps -even as government data shows fewer than one in five international students ever obtain permanent residency.
- Financial precarity among currently enrolled students is intensifying year-on-year, with over a quarter of surveyed students in late 2025 saying they had considered withdrawing from their course and returning home.

Australia is not alone in tightening -the UK and Canada are moving in a similar direction -but New Zealand offers a live counter-case, having reversed its own 2022 tightening from 2024 onward specifically to remain competitive. Section 5 sets out where each of six major study destinations now stands.

Five Strategic Priorities for Australian Universities

Before the evidence: what the data in this paper points institutions toward doing. The detailed findings supporting each priority follow in Sections 1 through 4.

- 1. Embed employability before enrolment** - connect course choice to realistic, study-area-specific labour market outcomes at the point of offer, not after graduation. The gap between the best and worst-performing study areas exceeds 30 percentage points -this is a pre-enrolment decision, not a careers-service problem.
- 2. Mandate work-integrated learning during study** - QILT's own analysis attributes much of the postgraduate coursework gap to international graduates lacking labour market experience prior to further study. Structured internships during the study period address this directly, rather than waiting for graduation to be the first point of labour market contact.
- 3. Build named employer partnerships, not generic career fairs** - a meaningful share of skills underutilisation is attributed by graduates themselves to employer preference for permanent residents, independent of skill. Institutions with a demonstrable track record with specific employer cohorts have genuine leverage here that generic career services do not.
- 4. Develop alumni career ecosystems that outlast the visa clock** - with under 20% of international students obtaining permanent residency, an institution's relationship with a graduate does not end at the temporary graduate visa's expiry -nor should its employability data collection. Alumni who leave Australia remain a reputational and recruitment asset if the relationship is maintained.
- 5. Set expectations before arrival, not after enrolment** - 74% of surveyed students underestimated job search difficulty and 85% underestimated cost of living. Closing this expectation gap pre-arrival is where financial distress and course withdrawal risk can actually be reduced -after arrival, the damage to retention and satisfaction metrics is already underway.

What This Means for Your Institution

Every finding in this paper ultimately reduces to a small set of metrics that Australian university leadership already tracks. The table below maps the evidence in this paper directly onto those metrics.

Institutional KPI	Where This Paper's Evidence Applies
Graduate Outcomes Survey (QILT) performance	Section 1 data is the same data set your GOS results are drawn from -international cohort performance directly affects institutional averages and compared standing.
QS / THE Rankings (Employer Reputation, Employability)	Employer Reputation and Employment Outcomes are explicit QS ranking indicators. Section 1's study-area gap analysis shows exactly where ranking exposure concentrates by faculty.
International recruitment & source-market health	Section 5's cross-market comparison shows where Australia now sits competitively -directly relevant to recruitment planning for India, Nepal, and China pipelines.
Student satisfaction & retention	Section 4's financial distress data (26% considering withdrawal) is a direct leading indicator of retention risk and satisfaction survey exposure.
Government funding & regulatory standing	Section 2's enrolment cap mechanism ties institutional funding and growth directly to compliance and outcomes performance from 2025 onward.
Alumni engagement & employer partnerships	Section 1's skills-utilisation findings (graduates working below their qualification level) directly weaken the alumni outcomes institutions rely on for employer partnership renewal.

The remainder of this paper sets out the underlying evidence for each of these connections.

Competitive Landscape: Six Study Destinations

Australia's tightening is not happening in isolation, but it is also not universal. Some competitor destinations are tightening in parallel; others are deliberately loosening to capture the students Australia is filtering out; one is experiencing outright policy volatility.

Market	Post-Study Work Route	2024–26 Direction	Key Recent Change
Australia	Temporary Graduate visa (485)	Tightening	Fee more than doubled to A\$1,600; age capped at 35; enrolment caps from 2025
New Zealand	Post Study Work Visa	Loosening (post-2022)	New Short-Term Graduate Work Visa + broadened PSW eligibility, effective Nov 2025
United Kingdom	Graduate Route	Tightening	Duration cut from 2 years to 18 months for Bachelor's/Master's from Jan 2027
Canada	Post-Graduation Work Permit	Tightening	2026 new international student intake target cut 49%; PGWP field-of-study rules for non-degree programs
United States	Optional Practical Training (OPT)	Highly volatile	2025: heightened visa scrutiny, SEVP revocations, OPT itself under review for elimination
Singapore	None -employer-sponsored only	Structurally most restrictive	No independent post-study visa exists; Employment Pass requires SGD 5,000+/month salary

Sources: Department of Home Affairs (Australia); Immigration New Zealand; UK Government Graduate Route guidance; IRCC (Canada); Mayer Brown / DHS (United States); Ministry of Manpower (Singapore).

The strategic read: Australia now sits in the tightening cohort alongside the UK and Canada, while New Zealand is the only English-speaking peer market actively loosening settings to compete for the same applicant pool. For institutions competing on international recruitment, this is a two-to-three-year window in which New Zealand's relative positioning will improve unless Australia's settings change.

The Institutional Risk Cascade

The connection between graduate employability and institutional financial health is not indirect -it is a documented chain, each link of which shows up in a metric your institution already reports on.

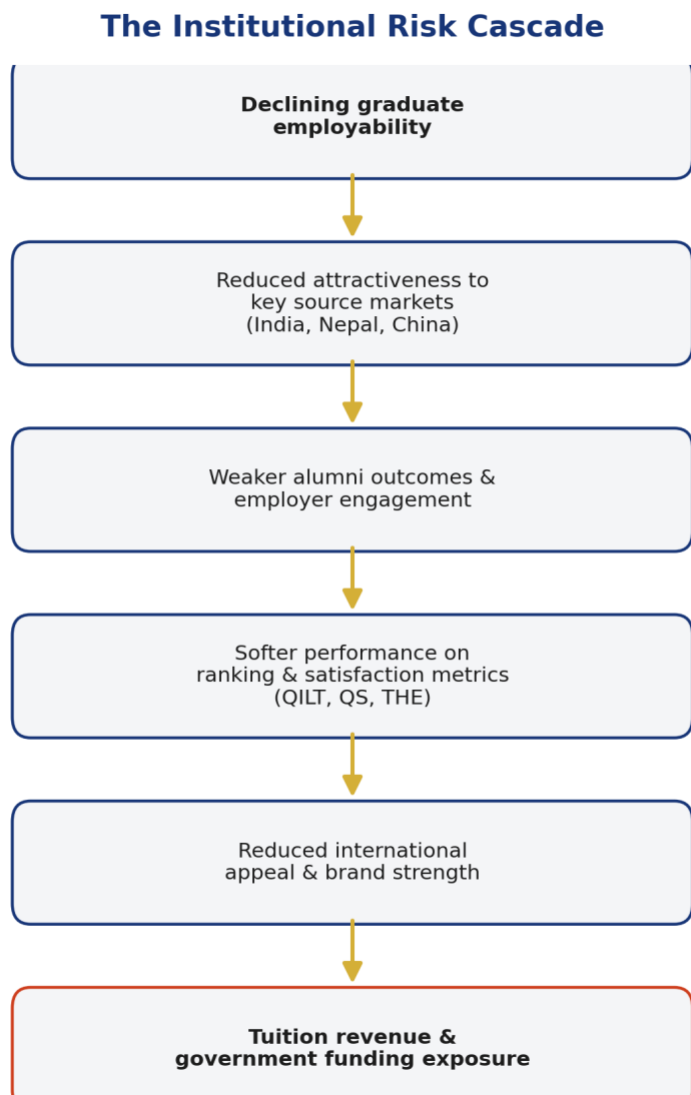


Figure: The institutional risk cascade from declining employability to funding exposure.

This cascade is not hypothetical. Jobs and Skills Australia's own 2025 research found that international students increasingly select courses, providers, and even specific campus locations based on perceived migration pathway strength rather than educational value -meaning recruitment decisions are already responding to exactly the employability and policy signals this paper documents. An institution that treats graduate employability as a downstream, post-enrolment concern is, in practice, already several steps behind where its prospective students are making decisions.

Pine's Alumni Intelligence: Already Mapped, Ready to Engage

Everything in this paper so far has been public research -deliberately, because that is what makes it credible as analysis. This section is different: it describes an asset Pine Careers has already built, not a recommendation for someone else to build.

Pine Careers has mapped alumni networks across 43 Australian and New Zealand universities -35 in Australia, 8 in New Zealand -covering more than 5.2 million alumni records across 28 global markets, including over 852,000 alumni now living and working outside Australia and New Zealand, concentrated in India, Singapore, the UK, the US, Canada, the Gulf, and continental Europe.

43 Australian & NZ universities with mapped alumni networks	5.2M+ Alumni records mapped across 28 global markets	852K+ Internationally-based alumni identified outside Australia/NZ
---	--	--

The institutions with the largest mapped networks -RMIT, Monash, the University of Melbourne, UNSW, the University of Sydney, and the University of Queensland among them -each have well over 200,000 mapped alumni, with tens of thousands based internationally. This is not a sample or a pilot; it is population-level coverage across the sector.

Why This Matters More Than the Number Itself

An alumni network of this scale is only valuable if it can be activated, and this is where the framing in Section: Five Strategic Priorities becomes concrete rather than aspirational. Mapped alumni -by definition, graduates who are already employed, often in roles and markets directly relevant to current students -are a ready-made pool of:

- Industry ambassadors and guest faculty who can speak with current credibility about a specific sector, market, or employer
- Mentors for current students navigating the exact employability gap documented in Section 1
- Hiring referral sources, particularly valuable given Section 1's finding that employer preference for permanent residents -not lack of skill -explains much of international graduate underutilisation
- Panel and advisory board participants for industry-facing curriculum review

Engagement, not exposure

Pine does not release named alumni contact data to any institution ahead of a formal partnership agreement. Activation -introductions, outreach, chapter formation, ambassador programmes -proceeds only on mutual consent between the institution and Pine Careers, consistent with the alumni data protection standards both parties owe their graduates. What is already true today, independent of any agreement, is that the network exists and its scale is known.

A Precedent, Not a Pilot

This is not the first time Pine has built and activated a mapped alumni network for a partner institution. A comparable alumni mapping and engagement programme has already been delivered for two UK universities, following the same methodology described above -institution-level mapping, market-by-market segmentation, and phased activation into mentorship, guest faculty, and referral programmes. The Australia/New Zealand network described in this section is the same capability applied at a larger scale, ahead of any specific institutional engagement, rather than an idea proposed for the first time in this paper.

How the Network Is Built

Scale alone does not establish credibility -provenance does. Pine's alumni mapping is built through a proprietary AI-assisted identification process, cross-checked by a manual verification team rather than left as an unaudited automated output. The system carries a built-in failsafe ceiling of a maximum 20% error rate, and that accuracy rate is independently and instantly spot-checkable on request -not a figure institutions are asked to take on trust.

Equally important is the distinction between mapped and engaged. Being mapped means an alumnus has been identified and located within a given market; it does not mean they have been contacted or have consented to engagement. Outreach, consent capture, and activation into mentorship, guest faculty, or ambassador roles happen only once an institution formally commissions the engagement -which is also the point at which Pine is compensated to do so. Aggregate, demography-level figures (institution, market, volume) can be shared ahead of any agreement; named, individual-level alumni data is proprietary and is shared only after a formal partnership is in place.

To make this concrete rather than abstract, Pine can provide a live proof-of-concept sample of 5–10 alumni from a specific institution at any time, on request -not a scheduled demo, but a real-time demonstration of the mapping's accuracy and depth for the institution evaluating it.

The Evidence Base

The remaining sections set out, in full, the data underlying the priorities and risk framing above -the employability gap itself, the policy timeline driving it, the New Zealand counter-case, and the 2025 financial distress evidence.

1. The Employability Gap, by the Numbers

The single most authoritative source on this question is the Graduate Outcomes Survey (GOS), run annually since 2016 by the Australian Government's QILT program. International graduate outcomes have been published as a standalone annual report since 2021, allowing direct year-on-year comparison against domestic graduates using identical methodology.

In 2024, the full-time employment rate for international undergraduates was 52.3%, compared to 74.0% for domestic graduates -a 21.7 percentage point gap, up from 19.3 points in 2023. At the postgraduate coursework level the gap was even larger: 56.1% versus 88.1%, a 32.0 point difference, up from 29.6 points the year before. Only at the postgraduate research level has the gap narrowed, with international graduates holding above 75% full-time employment for three consecutive years.

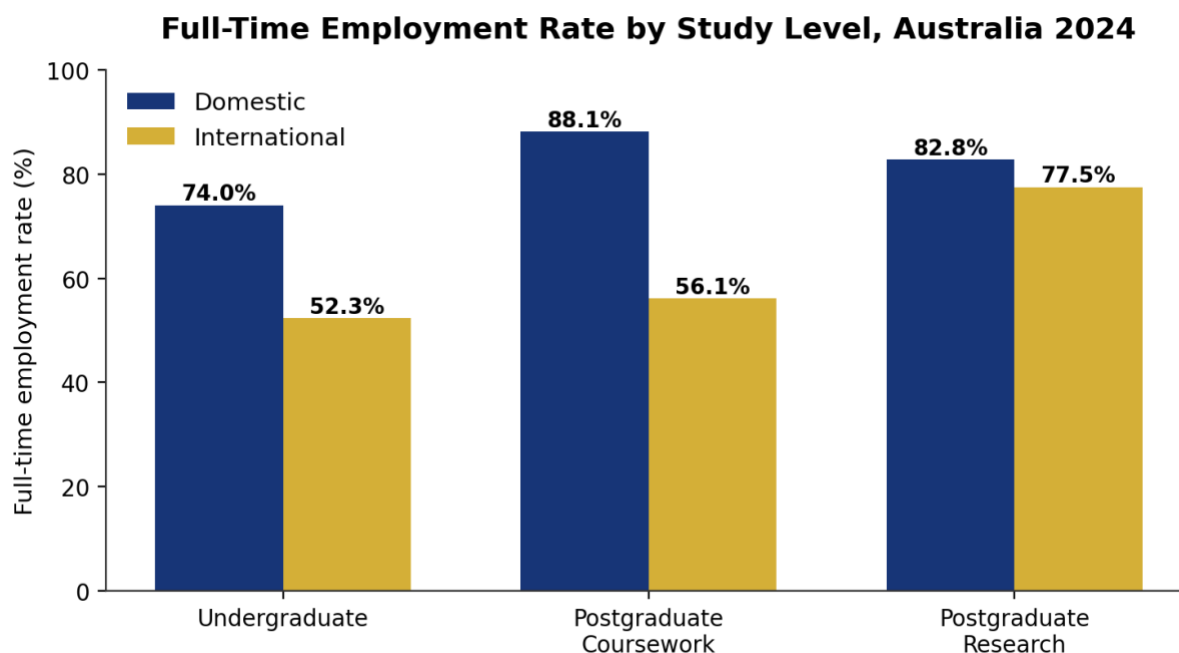


Figure 1. Full-time employment rate by study level and citizenship status, Australia 2024. Source: QILT 2024 Graduate Outcomes Survey, International Report.

This is not a new phenomenon -the gap has existed since the GOS began -but it is a widening one. The chart below tracks undergraduate full-time employment for both cohorts since 2016, through the pandemic-era disruption and the tight post-2022 labour market, to the renewed widening in 2024.

Undergraduate Full-Time Employment Rate, 2016-2024

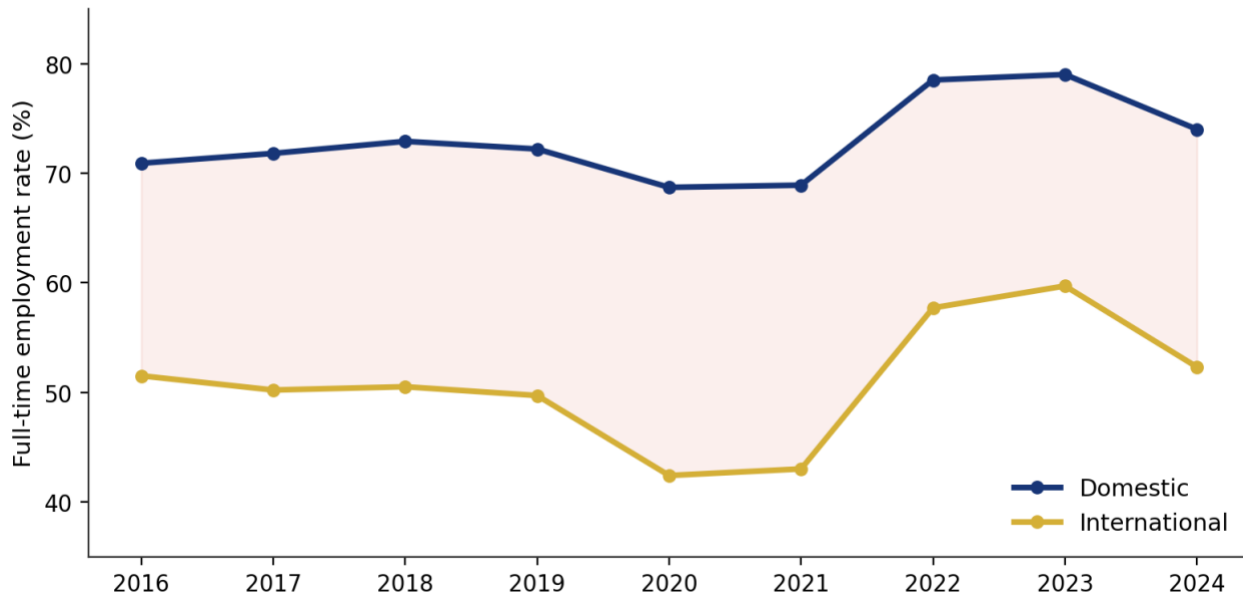


Figure 2. Undergraduate full-time employment rate, 2016–2024. Source: QILT Graduate Outcomes Survey, International & National Reports.

The gap is not confined to employment rates. Median salaries follow the same pattern, and the disparity compounds at higher qualification levels rather than narrowing, as it does for domestic graduates.

Median Graduate Salary by Study Level, Australia 2024

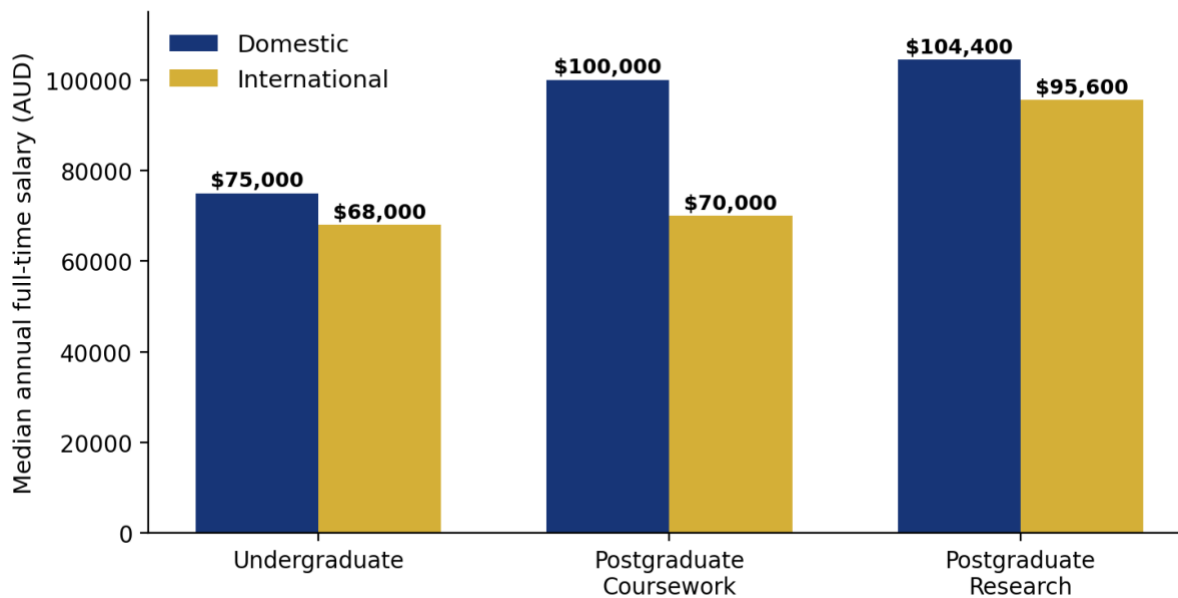


Figure 3. Median annual full-time salary by study level, Australia 2024. Source: QILT 2024 Graduate Outcomes Survey.

The postgraduate coursework salary gap -\$30,000 -is the starkest single figure in the entire data set. QILT's own analysis attributes much of this to age and experience profile rather than course quality: international postgraduate coursework graduates are disproportionately young (75.9% aged 30 or under, versus 34.8% of domestic graduates) and are more likely to have moved directly from an undergraduate degree into postgraduate study without labour market experience in between. But this structural explanation does not change the number a graduating student, or a hiring employer, actually sees -nor the ranking and reputation exposure it creates for the institution, as set out earlier in this paper.

Underemployment, Not Just Unemployment

Employment rate alone understates the gap. International graduates who are employed are considerably more likely to be underemployed -working part-time while wanting more hours -than domestic graduates, and this rate rose in 2024 after two years of improvement.

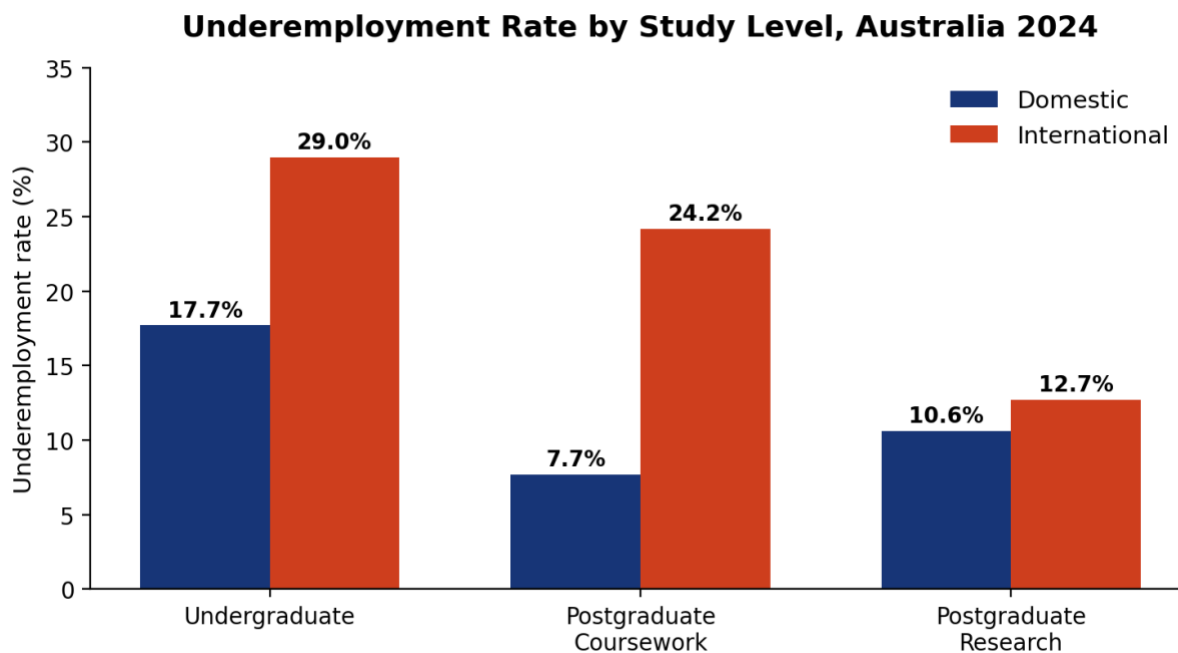


Figure 4. Underemployment rate by study level, Australia 2024 (proportion of employed graduates working part-time who would prefer more hours). Source: QILT 2024 GOS International Report.

A structural barrier unique to one cohort

Among underemployed graduates, 14.7% of international undergraduates and 13.3% of international postgraduate coursework graduates cited 'visa restrictions / waiting for permanent residency' as their main reason for not working more hours. The equivalent figure for domestic graduates was 0.0% -this is not a barrier that can appear in a domestic

graduate's response set. It is the only reason in the entire QILT questionnaire that is, by definition, exclusive to international students.

Why Undergraduates Aren't Working More Hours, Australia 2024

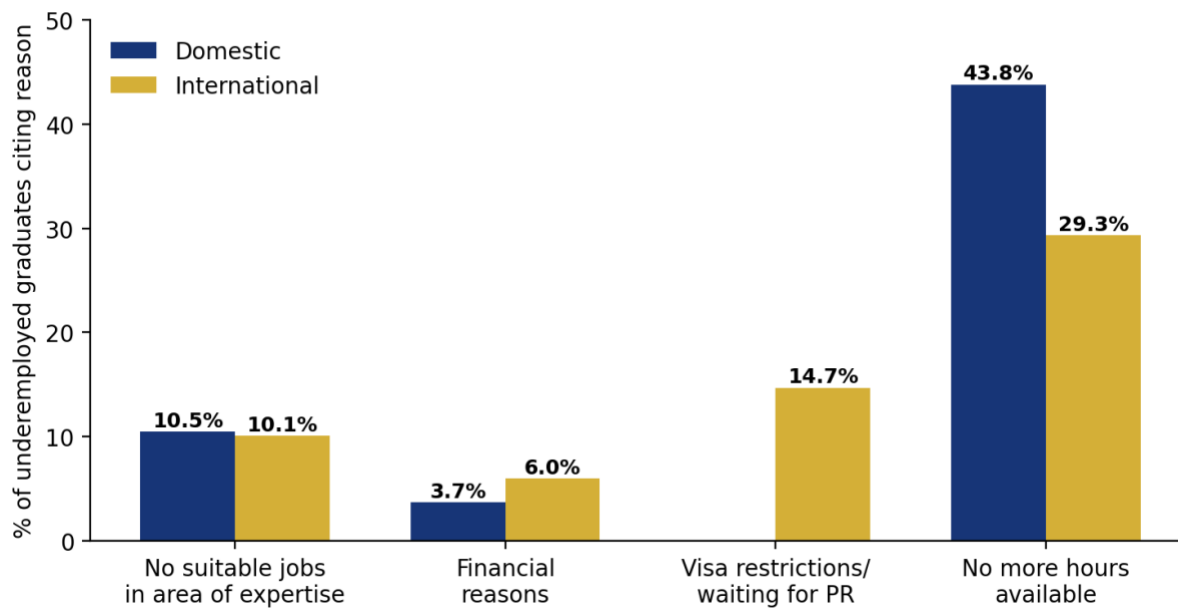


Figure 5. Reasons undergraduates report not working more hours, by citizenship status, 2024. Source: QILT 2024 GOS International Report, Table 3.

Not All Study Areas Are Equal

Averages conceal enormous variation by field of study. Some study areas -Dentistry, Pharmacy, Medicine -show near-parity between domestic and international full-time employment, reflecting genuine excess demand for those specific skills regardless of citizenship. Others show gaps exceeding 25 percentage points.

Largest Employability Gaps by Study Area, Undergraduate 2024

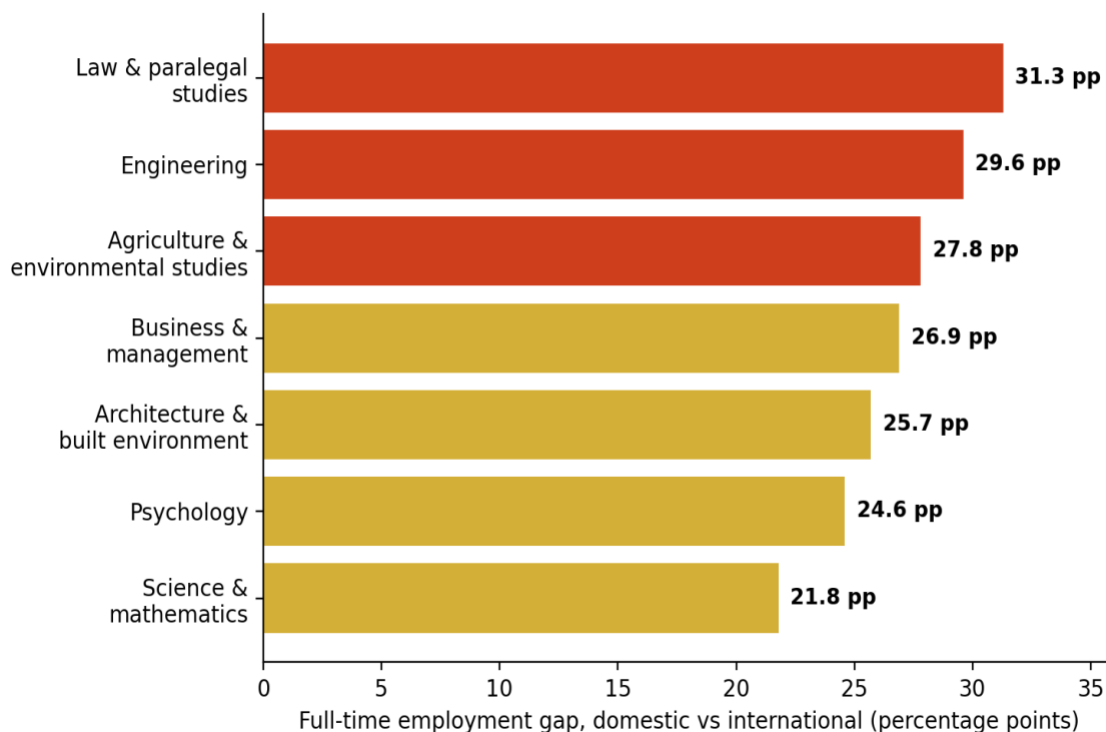


Figure 6. Largest full-time employment gaps by study area, undergraduate level, 2024. Source: QILT 2024 GOS International Report, Table 4.

Law and paralegal studies shows the single largest gap in the data set at 31.3 percentage points, followed by Engineering (29.6 points) and Agriculture and environmental studies (27.8 points). Business and management -by far the largest field of study for international students, accounting for over a quarter of the entire international cohort -shows a 26.9 point gap and a \$12,000 salary differential, meaning the single most common course of study for international students in Australia also carries one of the largest employability penalties. This is precisely the study-area-level detail Strategic Priority 1 (Section: Five Strategic Priorities) calls for embedding into pre-enrolment advising.

The Compounding Effect: Further Study as a Holding Pattern

International undergraduates are almost twice as likely as domestic graduates to move directly into further full-time study rather than the workforce. QILT's data suggests this is at least partly a rational response to weak initial labour market outcomes, not simply a preference for more education.

International Graduates Are ~2x More Likely to Re-Enrol

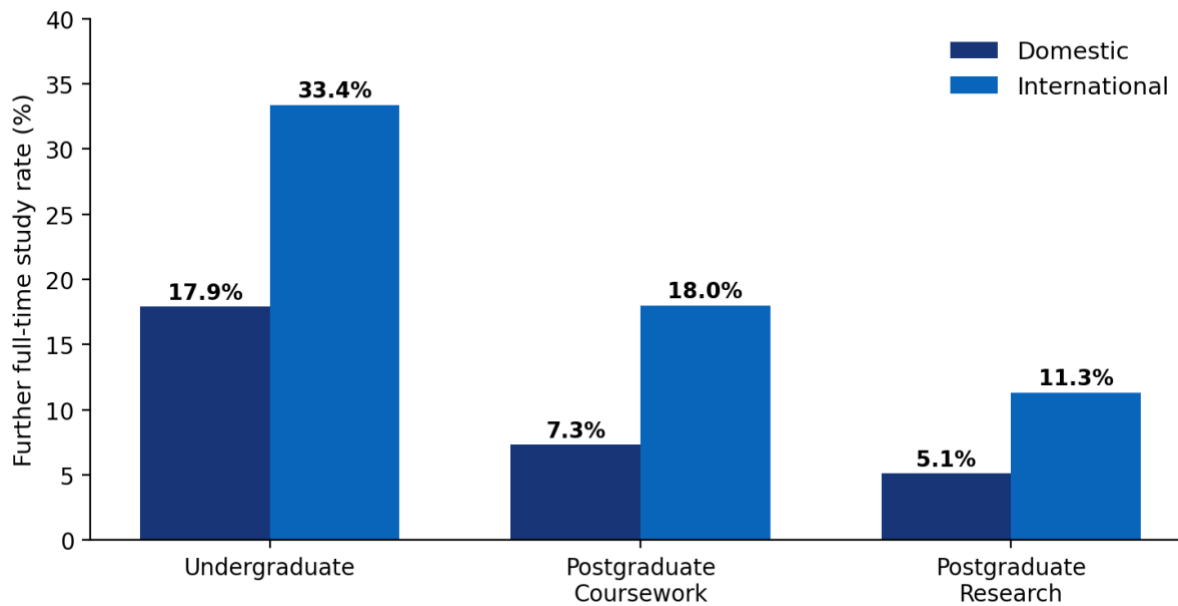


Figure 7. Further full-time study rate by study level and citizenship status, 2024. Source: QILT 2024 GOS International Report, Figure 11.

This matters because it delays labour market entry precisely when international graduates are already starting from a weaker position -and it means the postgraduate coursework cohort is disproportionately populated by graduates without the workforce experience that would otherwise narrow the gap. It is worth noting one genuine bright spot in the data: employed international graduates report higher levels of feeling well-prepared for their current job than domestic graduates do, across every study level. Whatever is driving the employability gap, it is not a preparedness or quality-of-education problem in the eyes of graduates themselves.

2. The Policy Reset: Visa Reform in Australia, 2021–2026

Since December 2023, the Australian Government has implemented nine separate migration policy changes affecting international students, with further reforms taking effect through 2025. Individually, several of these changes have defensible policy rationale -raising English language standards, tightening financial capacity checks, and closing loopholes used for 'visa hopping' between student and graduate visas. Collectively, they represent the most significant tightening of international education settings in over a decade, all landing on the same cohort within a three-year window.

Australia: The Tightening Timeline, 2021–2025



Figure 8. Timeline of major Australian visa and migration policy changes affecting international students, 2021–2025. Sources: Australian Government Migration Strategy (Dec 2023); Department of Home Affairs; Jobs and Skills Australia.

What Changed, and Why It Matters for Employability

- Genuine Student requirement (March 2024): replaced the Genuine Temporary Entrant test, adding new questions designed to assess whether an applicant's primary intent is study rather than migration or work.
- English language thresholds (March 2024): the Student visa minimum rose from IELTS 5.5 to 6.0; the Temporary Graduate visa minimum rose from 6.0 to 6.5 -directly relevant to employability, since language proficiency is one of the most commonly cited employer concerns in hiring international graduates.

- Financial capacity requirement (May 2024): raised 17% to approximately A\$24,505, pegged to 75% of the national minimum wage.
- Visa application fee (July 2024): more than doubled, from A\$710 to A\$1,600 -among the highest student visa fees of any major English-speaking study destination.
- Onshore pathway closures (July 2024): Temporary Graduate visa holders and Visitor visa holders can no longer apply for a Student visa while onshore; they must depart Australia first.
- Temporary Graduate visa reforms (July 2024): the visa was streamlined from four work-rights streams to three, length of stay was reduced, and a new age cap was introduced, alongside a ban on graduates over 35 accessing the visa at all.
- Enrolment caps (2025 onward): amendments to the ESOS Act empower the Education Minister to cap new international student enrolments by provider and by campus location, with the first caps applying to new students from 2025 and extending to continuing students in later years.

The permanent residency reality check

Fewer than 20% of international students who study in Australia ever obtain permanent residency. The policy tightening described above is being implemented for a cohort of whom more than four in five will not stay long-term -yet Jobs and Skills Australia's August 2025 study found that roughly 70% of international higher education students cited the possibility of migration as a reason for choosing to study in Australia in the first place, rising to 77% of Indian and 79% of Nepali students. The gap between why students come and what most of them will actually get is, itself, a structural source of the frustration and financial strain documented in Section 4.

The scale of the shift in international student contribution to net overseas migration (NOM) helps explain the political urgency behind these changes. International students contributed an estimated 270,000 to NOM in 2022-23 alone -170,000 more than in 2018-19 -as post-pandemic pent-up demand collided with a housing and rental affordability crisis. The Government's own projections show total NOM falling from 510,000 in 2022-23 to a targeted 250,000 by 2024-25, with international education settings doing much of that work.

3. New Zealand: A Different Direction

New Zealand offers a genuinely useful comparison because it followed a similar tightening trajectory through 2022 -and then reversed it. Where Australia has continued adding restrictions through 2025, New Zealand has spent the past two years deliberately loosening settings to remain competitive for the same pool of prospective students Australia is now filtering more aggressively.

New Zealand: Tighten, Then Loosen to Compete, 2021-2025



Figure 9. Timeline of New Zealand visa and post-study work policy changes, 2021–2025. Source: Immigration New Zealand; The PIE News; Education Counts.

New Zealand's 2022 'Immigration Rebalance' restricted Post Study Work Visa eligibility to degree-level qualifications of 30 weeks or more and raised financial thresholds -a tightening that mirrors Australia's later moves. But from late 2024, the direction reversed: post-study work eligibility was broadened to cover postgraduate diploma-to-master's transitions, part-time work during study was simplified by removing a permit requirement, and in July 2025 the government announced a new Short-Term Graduate Work Visa alongside further extensions to post-study work eligibility, explicitly framed as a competitiveness measure against Australia, the UK, and Canada.

The practical effect is that two countries sharing a labour market region, similar education systems, and overlapping source countries for international students are now running opposite policy experiments at the same time. Early evidence -a 67% enrolment rebound in New Zealand in 2023, alongside sharply rising Australian visa

refusal rates from key markets like India -suggests students are already responding to the divergence, though visa refusal rates in New Zealand have also risen for the same markets, indicating both countries are exercising more selectivity even as their public messaging diverges.

4. The Emerging Job Crisis

Behind the aggregate employment statistics is a currently-enrolled student population reporting rapidly worsening financial conditions. A survey of almost 2,200 international students conducted in late 2025 by an arm of insurance group Allianz found deteriorating conditions on every measure tracked year-on-year.

74% Underestimated how hard it would be to find suitable work (up from 57% in 2024)	85% Found cost of living significantly more expensive than expected (up from 62% in 2024)	26% Considered withdrawing from their course and returning home
---	---	---

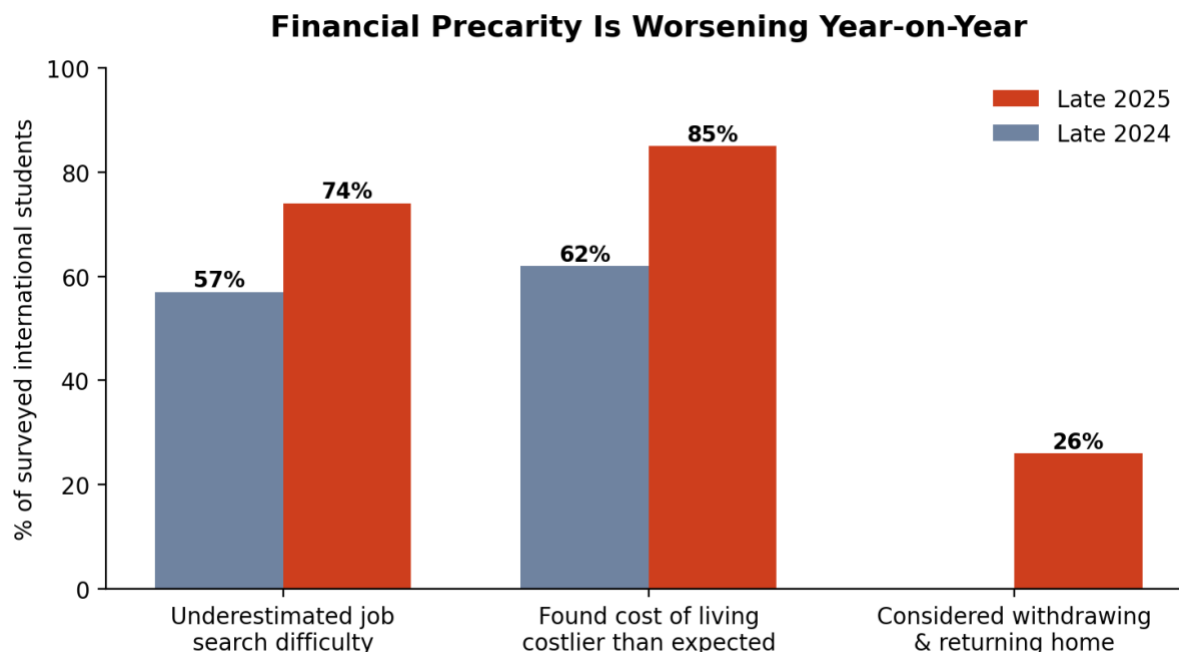


Figure 10. Year-on-year change in international student financial distress indicators, Australia. Source: Allianz Partners international student survey, late 2024 vs. late 2025 (n≈2,200).

Fewer than one in eight respondents described themselves as financially secure. Roughly half said they were relying on personal savings or family support to get by. The report's authors identified cost of living as “the defining pressure of the student experience” -not course quality, not homesickness, not academic difficulty, but the basic economics of remaining in the country while studying.

A Widening Enforcement Gap on Work Rights

Part of the pressure is structural. The fortnightly work-hours cap for student visa holders was raised from 40 to 48 hours after pandemic-era unrestricted work rights were scrapped -itself a tightening relative to the emergency

settings of 2020–22, even though it is framed publicly as a concession. Students describe the cap as insufficient given rising accommodation costs, which in Sydney and Melbourne now average A\$1,200–A\$2,000 of a A\$2,200–A\$3,200 monthly cost-of-living estimate.

Jobs and Skills Australia's August 2025 Pathways and Outcomes Study adds a further dimension: the Temporary Graduate visa cohort is now the largest single group of long-term temporary labour migrants in Australia, a cohort JSA states was intended to supply skilled workers into shortage occupations. Instead, separate reporting drawing on the same QILT data found that international graduates are frequently “underpaid, underutilised” relative to their qualifications -the skills utilisation findings in Section 1 in another form.

Two crises intersecting, not two crises coinciding

The employability gap (Section 1) and the financial distress trend (this section) are not independent phenomena arriving at the same time by coincidence. A graduate who is more likely to be underemployed, more likely to be working outside their field, and structurally barred from working additional hours by visa condition is, by definition, a graduate with less capacity to absorb rising living costs. The visa tightening in Section 2 -higher fees, stricter English thresholds, closed onshore pathways -raises the cost of entry into this system at precisely the moment the system is delivering weaker outcomes once you are inside it.

Reading the Evidence Together

Individually, each data set in this paper could be read as a partial story. Graduate outcomes data alone could be explained by age and experience differences. Visa policy alone could be read as reasonable integrity measures. Student financial distress alone could be attributed to cost-of-living pressure affecting everyone in Australia's largest cities, not international students specifically.

Read together, a cohort faces a widening employability gap, entering that labour market under progressively stricter and more expensive visa conditions, while reporting fast-deteriorating ability to meet basic living costs - and, per JSA's own 2025 findings, having chosen Australia substantially because of a migration pathway that fewer than one in five will ever obtain. This is the operating environment for any institution, employer, or intermediary engaging with international students in Australia today, and it is already visible in the recruitment-decision data JSA has published.

Closing

The international education market is entering a new era in which student recruitment alone will no longer define institutional success. The universities that differentiate themselves over the next decade will be those able to demonstrate measurable graduate outcomes, meaningful employer engagement, and structured employability ecosystems from enrolment through to alumni. Graduate employability is no longer simply a careers service responsibility; it has become a strategic institutional capability -and, per the risk cascade set out earlier in this paper, one with a direct line to recruitment, ranking, and revenue.

Methodology & Sources

This paper draws exclusively on official government and government-commissioned data sources, supplemented by peer-reviewed policy analysis and reputable education-sector reporting. No commercial or promotional sources were used for graduate outcomes or policy data.

Primary Data Sources

- Quality Indicators for Learning and Teaching (QILT), Graduate Outcomes Survey -2024 International Report and 2024 National Report, Australian Government Department of Education. qilt.edu.au
- Australian Government, Migration Strategy, released 11 December 2023, Department of Home Affairs.
- Jobs and Skills Australia, International Students Pathways and Outcomes Study, August 2025.
- Allianz Partners, International Student Survey, late 2025 (n≈2,200), as reported by Times Higher Education.
- Immigration New Zealand, post-study work visa policy announcements and news centre releases, 2021–2025.
- UK Government, Graduate Route guidance and May 2025 Immigration White Paper; HESA Graduate Outcomes Survey.
- Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC), Post-Graduation Work Permit policy updates, 2024–2025.
- Mayer Brown, “The International Student Talent Pipeline: Changes in US Visa and Work Authorization Policies,” May 2025.
- Singapore Ministry of Manpower, work pass and Employment Pass guidance.
- Andrew Norton, “International students: A government changes its mind,” ANU Migration Hub Insights No. 24/3.
- The Conversation, “Australia made 9 changes to student migration rules over the past year,” analysis of Department of Home Affairs and Department of Education data.

Notes on Interpretation

Full-time employment rate is defined by QILT as the proportion of graduates working 35+ hours per week among those available for full-time work, measured 4–6 months post-completion -a short-term measure that will differ from medium-term (3-year) outcomes captured separately by the GOS-Longitudinal survey. Underemployment figures reflect graduates working part-time who would prefer more hours, regardless of whether additional hours were available to them. All salary figures are nominal (not inflation-adjusted) and reflect graduates employed full-time within Australia only. Percentage point (“pp”) figures throughout this paper refer to the arithmetic difference between two percentages, not a relative percentage change. Cross-market comparisons in Section 5 (Competitive Landscape) reflect policy settings as publicly announced at time of writing and are subject to change; visa rules for UK, Canada, and US in particular were under active review at time of publication.

The Pine International Employability Framework, and Pine Region groupings where referenced, reflect Pine Careers' internal analytical methodology and market segmentation, and are distinct from the source data providers' own classifications.